Focus Hx of cough

Saturday, January 8, 2022 2:26 PM

❖ **History of present illness**

1. Onset
2. Duration
3. dry or productive
4. Day or night
5. Coming in episode or paroxysmal
6. Is there sticky sputum ?
7. Getting relief after couching sputum ?
8. Quality of the cough, harsh or soft
9. Patterns of the cough
10. precipitating factor
11. Relationship with position
12. Other symptoms (SOB, wheeze, chest tightness, fever, night sweats, wt loss)
13. Complications
14. Association with fever or night sweating > TB

❖ **Systemic enquiry**

➢ **CPS**

- SOB
- Palpitation
- Chest pain
- Hemoptysis
- Syncope attack

❖ **PMH**

- Cardiac disease
- Asthma
- Chronic lung disease
- TB
- contact with pt with chronic cough
- Chronic allergic sinusitis

❖ **Family history**

- Similar condition
- TB, Asthma , Allergic

❖ **Social history**

- Socioeconomic class
- Ventilation
- Any smokers
- Presence of chronic irritant

❖ **Drug history**

- Anti tuberous therapy

➢ **All cases are dry cough except in few conditions like**

- Kartagener syndrome
- bronchiectasis
- Cystic fibrosis

❖ **Notes**

- Cough at night > Cardiac problem
- Cough at early morning > Respiratory problem

➢ **Paroxysmal Cough DDx**

- allergies conditions
  - Bronchial asthma
  - Allergic rhinitis
- Whooping cough
- bronchiectasis

➢ sticky sputum > airway obstruction

➢ **Cough with sputum DDx**

- Bronchial asthma
- Kartagener syndrome
- bronchiectasis
- Cystic fibrosis

- Cough with Exercise ➔ **asthma**
- Barking harsh Cough ➔ **Croup**
- Cough with Wheezing ➔ Bronchiolitis, asthma
- Staccato cough ➔ C.pneumonia, respiratory infections and allergies
- Feeding problem ➔ may suggest **Tracheo-esophageal fistula**
- Abdominal pain ➔ bacterial pneumonia
- Weight loss or poor weight gain and foul-smelling stools ➔**cystic fibrosis.**
- Muscle soreness ➔ viral illness or atypical pneumonia
- For most children, episodes of cough are due to URTI
- Wet soft cough ➔ lower respiratory tract problem
- Dry harsh cough ➔ upper respiratory tract problem
- 1 large bout of cough > large upper airway
- 2_3 small bouts > medium upper airway
- Small repeated bouts > small airways & alveoli
- Cough related to position can be > laryngomalacia

➢ **Complications of cough**

- Conjunctiva hemorrhage
- Chest tightness
- Umbilical hernia
- Hemorrhoids
- Rectal prolapse

- Foreign body aspiration > children 6 months to 6 yrs

❖ **Causes of recurrent or persistent cough**

- Recurrent respiratory infections.
- Post-specific respiratory infections (pertussis, RSV, Mycoplasma).
- Asthma.
- Suppurative lung diseases (cystic fibrosis, ciliary dyskinesia or immune deficiency).
- Recurrent aspiration (± gastro-esophageal reflux).
- Persistent endobronchial infection.
- Inhaled foreign body.
- Cigarette smoking (active or passive).
- Tuberculosis.
- Habit cough.
- Airway anomalies (tracheo-bronchomalacia, tracheo-esophageal fistula).

❖ **Management**

- Management of the underlying disorder.
- Supportive care (oxygen, bronchodilators as needed) for viral infections.
- Antibiotics for bacterial pneumonia
- Bronchodilators and anti-inflammatory drugs for asthma
- Little evidence exists to support the use of cough suppressants and mucolytic agents.